

Leocadia Duskmere

Character Dossier

Sunny and relentlessly optimistic herbalist of the Academy of Vell

Overview

Leocadia Duskmere is a herbalist living in the Academy of Vell. Leocadia is 30 years old, originally from Marrow's End, and is known around the Hall of Echoes as sunny and relentlessly optimistic. In conversation Leocadia tells long stories that circle back to the point eventually.

Background

Leocadia arrived in the Academy of Vell 26 years ago after leaving Marrow's End under circumstances Leocadia describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Faculty of Applied Wonders; the second was the one that stuck. Today Leocadia works as a herbalist near the north observatory and is paid, when paid at all, in guilders.

Leocadia learned the trade from Eamon Blackwater, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Leocadia's life is with Yevgenia Corvane, over a matter neither will explain. The person Leocadia trusts most is Amadou Lindqvist.

Current goal: to build a boat with no nails in it. Greatest fear: a knock at the door after dark.

Personality and speech

Temperament: sunny and relentlessly optimistic.

Speech pattern: Leocadia tells long stories that circle back to the point eventually.

Tells: when lying, Leocadia mentions Saucer the gecko for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Leocadia Duskmere
Role	herbalist
Home	the Academy of Vell
Hometown	Marrow's End
Age	30
Favourite dish	midnight black garlic noodles
Pet	Saucer, a gecko
Lucky number	421

<i>Workshop password</i>	fern-meadow
<i>Mentor</i>	Eamon Blackwater
<i>Rival</i>	Yevgenia Corvane
<i>Closest friend</i>	Amadou Lindqvist

Secret

Leocadia secretly funds an orphanage in Marrow's End and would be mortified if anyone found out.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Leocadia: I am the herbalist. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Leocadia: Midnight black garlic noodles. Do not tell Yevgenia I said so.

Visitor: Is Saucer yours?

Leocadia: Saucer belongs to nobody. Saucer tolerates me. Lucky number is 421, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, summer of year 32

The weather turned. Leocadia moved the hand bell indoors, fed Saucer, and wrote three lines to Eamon about the new curfew. The weather turned. Leocadia moved the glass float indoors, fed Saucer, and wrote three lines to Eamon about the harvest count. Leocadia was hired to carry a grain scale from the greenhouse cloisters to the candle library without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Rumours about the census reached the greenhouse cloisters. Leocadia pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 2, spring of year 32

the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about whether the bridge will hold. Leocadia read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the singing at the docks. Leocadia read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A dispute over the new curfew flared up between Leocadia and Yevgenia outside the Hall of Echoes; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Leocadia was hired to carry a bundle of letters from the Hall of Echoes to the north observatory without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 3, summer of year 32

Leocadia found a bundle of letters half-buried near the candle library and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. The weather turned. Leocadia moved the clockwork bird indoors, fed Saucer, and wrote three lines to Eamon about the missing shipment. At the candle library, Leocadia taught Amadou how to tell a real clockwork bird from a fake one by weight alone. Someone left a grain scale on the doorstep with no note. Leocadia suspects Amadou and is probably right. Leocadia spent the day counting stock at the candle library: 59 of everything, except the glass float, which is always short.

Entry 4, autumn of year 32

Leocadia closed early, walked to the bell tower, and watched the lights come on. Saucer followed at a distance. A dispute over the singing at the docks flared up between Leocadia and Yevgenia outside the Hall of Echoes; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. The weather turned. Leocadia moved the bundle of letters indoors, fed Saucer, and wrote three lines to Eamon about the rumour of a second well.

Entry 5, winter of year 32

Leocadia closed early, walked to the bell tower, and watched the lights come on. Saucer followed at a distance. Tallulah came by asking about the tax on doors. Leocadia said nothing useful and made tea instead. the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Leocadia read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Leocadia spent the day counting stock at the candle library: 46 of everything, except the cracked compass, which is always short.

Entry 6, summer of year 32

Leocadia closed early, walked to the north observatory, and watched the lights come on. Saucer followed at a distance. Leocadia found a grain scale half-buried near the greenhouse cloisters and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Eamon visited unannounced. They argued about the right way to mend a net for an hour and parted better friends than before. Leocadia was hired to carry a iron kettle from the greenhouse cloisters to the north observatory without opening it, and mostly succeeded. the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the singing at the docks. Leocadia read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 7, spring of year 32

Leocadia repaired the signal flag at the north observatory for Fenwick, who paid in 83 guilders and a long story about the tax on doors. Leocadia was hired to carry a cracked compass from the north observatory to the Hall of Echoes without opening it, and mostly succeeded. At the north observatory, Leocadia taught Amadou how to tell a real tin whistle from a fake one by weight alone. A stranger asked Leocadia for the password to the workshop. Leocadia laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Leocadia spent the day counting stock at the north observatory: 45 of everything, except the hand bell, which is always short.

Entry 8, summer of year 32

Leocadia spent the day counting stock at the Hall of Echoes: 63 of everything, except the pair of spectacles, which is always short. Matthias came by asking about the comet. Leocadia said nothing useful and made tea instead. the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the new curfew. Leocadia read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Eamon visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. Leocadia was hired to carry a bolt of linen from the Hall of Echoes to the candle library without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 9, spring of year 32

Leocadia was hired to carry a brass lantern from the greenhouse cloisters to the north observatory without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Percival came by asking about the singing at the docks. Leocadia said nothing useful and made tea instead. Eamon visited unannounced. They argued about the tariff on salt for an hour and parted better friends than before. A stranger asked Leocadia for the password to the workshop. Leocadia laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 10, autumn of year 32

A stranger asked Leocadia for the password to the workshop. Leocadia laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. The weather turned. Leocadia moved the oilskin map indoors, fed Saucer, and wrote three lines to Eamon about the tariff on salt. Leocadia spent the day counting stock at the greenhouse cloisters: 73 of everything, except the copper pipe, which is always short. Leocadia spent the day counting stock at the greenhouse cloisters: 12 of everything, except the pair of spectacles, which is always short.

Entry 11, spring of year 32

Quillon came by asking about the old tunnels. Leocadia said nothing useful and made tea instead. Someone left a sack of salt on the doorstep with no note. Leocadia suspects Amadou and is probably

right. Rumours about the rumour of a second well reached the Hall of Echoes. Leocadia pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the old tunnels. Leocadia read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Rowan came by asking about the rumour of a second well. Leocadia said nothing useful and made tea instead.